

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

W E D N E S D A Y , O C T O B E R 1 , 2 0 2 5

Shutdown starts as acrimony intensifies

Both sides’ proposals blocked; partial closure is first since ’19

By Catie Edmondson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Parts of the federal government shut down on Wednesday morning at 12:01 a.m., amid a bitter spending deadlock between President Trump and Democrats in Congress that will disrupt federal services and leave many federal workers furloughed.

It was the first such shutdown since 2019, when parts of the government were shuttered for 35 days in a standoff between congressional Democrats and Trump over the president’s demand to fund a wall at the southern border.

The shutdown came after Democrats in Congress again blocked Republicans’ plan to keep federal funding flowing before a midnight deadline.

In back-to-back Senate votes that reflected the bitter spending deadlock, each party blocked the other’s stopgap spending proposal, just as they had earlier this month. It underscored how little progress has been made toward a compromise.

On a 55-45 vote, the GOP plan, which would extend funding through Nov. 21, fell short of the 60 needed for passage.

Republicans also blocked Democrats’ plan, which would extend funding through the end of October and add more than \$1 trillion in health care spending, in a 53-47 vote.

Shortly after the failed votes, the Senate ad-

SHUTDOWN, Page A7

‘I don’t take it lightly when I say that I think the shutdown is the lesser of the two evils we’re facing.’

JENNA NORTON, a program officer at the National Institutes of Health

Federal workers used to chaos wonder if things could get worse

By Tal Kopan, Julian E.J. Sorapuru, and Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As the midnight Tuesday deadline to fund the government was approaching, some workers who would be directly affected found themselves in an unusual position: Preferring a shutdown over continuing the chaotic status quo.

For the more than 2 million people employed by the federal government, a shutdown comes at a steep personal cost. Many will go without paychecks until Congress restores funding, with employees deemed as essential required to continue working without pay. And some could lose their jobs under an aggressive plan to reduce the size of government called for by budget director Russell Vought.

As civil servants, many are also painfully aware of the consequences of a shutdown for the people and programs they serve, with millions of Americans reliant on or impacted by government services. But ahead of the deadline, some workers wanted lawmakers to stand up for them in the face of the Trump administration’s unprecedented assault on the federal workforce and diversion of congressionally appropriated funds, even if it meant rejecting a so-called continuing

WORKERS, Page A7



ALEX KENT/NEW YORK TIMES

Democrats Chuck Schumer and Hakeem Jeffries spoke to reporters after meeting with President Trump earlier in the week.

A GREAT START AND FINISH FOR THE SOX



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Closer Aroldis Chapman celebrated after he escaped from a bases loaded, no outs jam in the bottom of the ninth with the Red Sox clinging to a 3-1 lead in the tense opener of the wild-card round at Yankee Stadium on Tuesday night. Despite the brilliant pitching of Garrett Crochet, the Sox trailed 1-0 until the seventh, when they rallied for two runs. With the win, Boston needs to take one of the next two games in the best of three to move on. Game 2 is today at 6. **C1.**

Judge gives foreign students a victory

In backing their free speech, he rules against US while warning about Trump

By Sean Cotter and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio

GLOBE STAFF

In a decision as striking for its pointed warnings about President Trump as it was for its legal conclusions, a federal judge in Boston on Tuesday ruled the federal government violated the free speech rights of international students who were singled out for deportation after they had spoken out or participated

in pro-Palestinian advocacy.

Senior District Judge William G. Young decided in favor of professors’ unions at Harvard and other schools that sued the Trump administration over its attempts to arrest, detain, and ultimately deport foreign pro-Palestinian student activists in the spring.

“This case perhaps the most important ever to fall within the jurisdiction of this district court

squarely presents the issue whether non-citizens lawfully present here in United States actually have the same free speech rights as the rest of us,” Young wrote in his 161-page decision. “The Court answers this Constitutional question unequivocally ‘yes, they do.’ ”

But Young seemed to sound a warning for the limits of what he and other courts could do in the face of a presidency he accused of brushing aside “the Constitution, our civil laws, regulations, mores, customs, ... The President simply ignores it all when he takes it into his head to

►US prosecutors seek to convince appeals court that Vermont judges shouldn’t have ordered release of student activists. A5.

act,” he wrote, adding: “Daunting prospect, isn’t it?”

The decision follows a two-week trial in July before the colorful long-time judge. During those proceedings, government officials acknowledged in testimony that some of the reasons why Tufts grad student Rümeyza Öztürk and several other students were targeted for arrest

FREE SPEECH, Page A5

Search for new school leader in Cambridge questioned

One finalist says he lost \$750,000 in a crypto scam and sued

By Spencer Buell

GLOBE STAFF

Before he was one of three finalists to be superintendent of Cambridge Public Schools, Lourenço Garcia made a costly mistake.

Over three weeks in late 2021 and early 2022, he withdrew \$751,500 of his own money to invest in a purported cryptocurrency platform, according to a lawsuit he filed.

Soon, the money was gone in what he said in court filings was “a scam.” Then he sued his bank for letting him do it.

Garcia, who is currently an assistant superintendent in Revere, has not yet

answered questions publicly about the lawsuit, or about separate allegations made against him during a 2013 divorce, as the city moves to fill the seat vacated by former superintendent Victoria Greer. The School Committee voted in 2024 to end her contract early.

The search process has come under criticism from teachers and elected leaders who, amid controversy over another candidate’s past, say the firm hired to help did not do enough to recruit quality applicants and account for obvious red flags in some candidates’ pasts. The teachers union has called for the School Committee to start the process over again.

Some School Committee members have queried Garcia in private sessions about the incidents as they consider the three finalists for the job of leading a district with 17 schools, a \$280 million

CAMBRIDGE, Page B3

Long-serving Mass. sheriffs on defensive amid scandals

By Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

The Massachusetts Constitution has empowered voters for 170 years to pick their county sheriffs. Even with a recent drumbeat of negative headlines, that may be news to many residents.

Before all 14 sheriffs were last on the ballot in 2022, an ACLU-commissioned poll found that just 10 percent of voters knew for how long a sheriff served. Eight of 10 couldn’t name the sheriff who represented them. And almost half didn’t even know that it’s an elected position, said Laura Rótolo, senior advocacy director for field initiatives at the ACLU of Massachusetts.

“Between [then] and 2028,” when

they’re next up for election, Rótolo said, “voters aren’t going to really be thinking about sheriffs.”

Recent events suggest perhaps they should. A series of criminal and civil allegations against county sheriffs has cast their positions in a renewed, if unflattering, light, rankling other Massachusetts sheriffs as their oft-observed offices face fresh scrutiny.

A state commission established last year is examining ways the state-run correctional facilities and sheriff-run county jails could be reshaped or even consolidated. Legislative leaders, alarmed by reported budget overruns in the sheriff’s departments, have been

SHERIFFS, Page A6



Look closer, Michelin

Devra First has some under-the-radar possibilities, like (clockwise from top left) Kaia, The Winsor House, and Yafa Bakery & Cafe. **G1.**

President Trump said his administration is close to finalizing an agreement with Harvard University but the school didn’t confirm it. **B1.**

Mass General Brigham said it would start on a project to transform Brigham and Women’s Longwood campus by replacing the Braunschweig building. **B5.**

President Trump proposed using American cities as training grounds for the armed forces and spoke of needing US military might to combat what he called the “invasion from within.” **A2.**

Qatar said that further talks were needed over details of President Trump’s peace plan aimed at ending the war in Gaza. **A3.**



Falling for it

Wednesday: Windy, cooler. High 61-66. Low 47-52.

Thursday: More of the same. High 59-64. Low 46-51.

High tide: 6:54 a.m., 7:03 p.m. Sunrise: 6:41 Sunset: 6:25

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 308, NO. 93

Suggested retail price \$4.00

